KEREM AKIN

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QuestBridge National College Match Finalist (2026) • College Prep Scholar (2026)

Senior at Spotswood High School with a record of academic excellence across three countries (Turkey, UAE, USA). Applying to engineering, with a strong interest in astrophysics; builds hands-on tools. Selected for the Virginia Governor's School for STEM and Rose-Hulman's Operation Catapult; 2nd in Virginia and 9th nationally in TSA Webmaster.

EDUCATION

Spotswood High School – Rockingham County, VA, USA *Aug 2025 – Jun 2027 (expected)*

*Grade 11–12 • **GPA: 4.28 weighted / 4.00 unweighted** • All A's across AP/Honors/DE coursework • National Honor Society Member*

- **Junior Year (Grade 11, completed — all A's):** AP English Language, AP Physics 1, DE Pre-Calculus; plus Chemistry II Honors, Biology II Honors, US History II Honors
- **Senior Year (Grade 12):** AP Physics 2, AP Chemistry, AP Statistics, AP Computer Science A, Honors Gov, AP World History, AP English Literature, DE Calculus — 6 APs + 1 DE

Dubai British School Emirates Hills (DBSEH) – Dubai, UAE *Aug 2023 – Jul 2025*

IGCSE/GCSE • All 8s & 9s across all subjects • Distinction in BTEC IT*

Horizon International School (HIS) – Dubai, UAE *Aug 2021 – Jul 2023*

Interschool chess representative • Basketball team

Primary & Middle Schools – Ankara, Türkiye *2015 – 2021*

Grades 1–6

STANDARDIZED TESTING

SAT: 1490 - **Math 790**, R & W 700 (Oct 2026) **AP:** 4 & 4 (Physics 1, Eng Lang) **GCSE:** All 8s & 9s (= A/A*)

HONORS & AWARDS

- **QuestBridge National College Match Finalist** — Selected as a Finalist in the National College Match (Oct 2026)
- **QuestBridge National College Admissions Conference** — Invited to attend in person; exclusive QB program for top Prep Scholars (2026)
- **TSA Webmaster** — 2nd Place, Virginia; 9th Place Nationally, TSA Nationals, June 2026
- **National Honor Society** — Member, Spotswood High School, 2025–present
- **College Board National Recognition Program —** Rural and Small-Town Recognition Award (2026)
- **UKMT Intermediate Mathematics Challenge** — Gold Award, Best in School (Dubai, 2024)
- **Certificate of Achievement** — Year 11 Maths Super League, Dubai, November 2024
- **Mental Mathematics** — Top in School, Horizon International School (Dubai)
- **UKMT Junior Mathematics Challenge** — Gold Certificate, Best in School (2022) • Junior Mathematics Olympiad (2022)
- **National Assessment Ranking** — 1st among 16,000 students, Turkey (2020)

COMPETITIVE PROGRAMS & SUMMER INSTITUTES

- **Virginia Governor's School for STEM** — Full scholarship; selective 3-week residential program at the University of Lynchburg (about 120 students selected from across Virginia); coursework incl. "The Dark Night Sky — Serious Questions for Real Astronomers" (college-level astronomy & astrophysics) (July 2026)
- **Rose-Hulman Institute of Technology — Operation Catapult** — Residential 2-week engineering program — led a 2-person team; designed and built a working catapult from scratch; 60% merit scholarship (June 2026)
- **Sabancı University Residential Program** — 2-week program: Machine Learning & AI, Python, Quantum Physics, Industrial Engineering (August 4–16, 2024)

EXTRACURRICULAR ACTIVITIES

- **TSA (Technology Student Association)** — Team Lead, Video Game Design (Unity); Webmaster: built ConnectHBG, a bilingual resource hub for newcomers (product lead, 15+ test rounds); also On Demand Video
- **Smartphone Microscope (TSA Eng. Design)** — CAD co-lead; 13 iterations; 4×/10×/40× lens carousel; State Conference
- **Sources of Strength** — Peer Leader (peer support & mental-health leadership program), 2025–present
- **Schoolhouse.world SAT Bootcamp Peer Tutor —** Volunteer tutor in a 4-week College Board bootcamp (2026)
- **Volunteer Math Tutor** — Tutored primary-school students in mathematics (Dubai, 2023)
- **Self-Taught Pursuits** — Game development in GameMaker/GML (built Shards of Balance, a 6-level 2D platformer: kerem-a.itch.io/shards-of-balance); Chess (Chess.com rapid ~1,100; HIS interschool tournament 2023); Piano (Grade 5–6 repertoire; performed at HIS & DBSEH school shows); Rubik's Cube (sub-45 sec)
- **Sports** — Basketball: 5 years; HIS secondary team (2023) • Football & Table Tennis

SKILLS & LANGUAGES

Languages: Turkish (Native) • English (Fluent) • Spanish (Intermediate; GCSE grade 9) • Arabic (Beginner)
Technical: Python • GameMaker (GML) • Unity • Microsoft Office Suite (Excel, Word, PowerPoint, Teams)